- Check for fetal lie and presentation
- Auscultate fetal heart sounds

What does it include?

- Measurement of fundal height
- Assessment of fetal lie and presentation
- Assessment of fetal movement
- Auscultation of fetal heart sounds
- Inspection for scars

Methods of Abdominal Examination

- Inspection
- Palpation
- Auscultation

Preparation for Abdominal Examination

- Ensure privacy
- Examination room should be well lighted and airy
- Woman is asked to empty her bladder
- Explain the women about the procedure/ process
- To make her comfortable, keep talking to her
- She lies supine with legs partially flexed
- Stand on her right side

First start with Inspection

- **Shape** - Check whether the uterine shape is ovoid or longitudinal or transverse or oblique
- **Size** - Appropriate to the weeks of pregnancy or not?
- **Skin Changes** - look for

Striae Gravidarum - (The brown and silvery lines all over the abdomen and)

Linea Niagra - (the pigmented line from the symphysis pubis to umblicus)

- **Cullen's Sign** - Bruishing discoloration around the umblicus
- **Scars** - Any incision scars present or not
- **Contour of the abdomen-** The general contour of the entire abdominal wall is observed. The contour should be checked carefully for distention and note must be made as to whether any distention is generalized or localized to a portion of the abdomen. Similarly, the flanks should be checked for any bulging
- **Check for visible foeta**l movements if not visible, confirm with the mother about the foetal movement



Striae Gravidarum



Linea Niagra

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